



If you are in regular contact with young children, it's even more important that you check your immunity to childhood illnesses.

CHILDHOOD ILLNESSES

Having immunity against common infectious illnesses will protect your unborn baby. You may have natural immunity from having conditions such as chicken pox and fifth disease as a child. You will almost certainly have been vaccinated against mumps and measles, so your unborn baby will be protected from these. If you are unsure about your immunity or medical history, or think you may have been in contact with any of these infections during pregnancy, contact your doctor immediately for further medical advice. They will be able to do a checkup and provide reassurance.

ASK A DOCTOR

I work for a dry cleaner. Could the chemicals harm my unborn baby? Concerns about dry-cleaning chemicals stem from research showing that women who operated dry-cleaning machines had a higher risk of miscarriage. If touched or inhaled, some organic (carbon-containing) solvents used in dry-cleaning machines can pass through the placenta and some are thought to increase the risk of miscarriage or birth defects.

Talk to your employer to find out how your duties can be changed for the duration of your pregnancy to limit your contact with organic solvents and industrial chemicals.